

7.4. Accessing inputs in an associative array

Sometimes, techniques may mess up the scripts with global variables. To confine the number of globals in a script, the features can be disabled for every form field by setting the 'register_globals' command to off in the php.ini file.

PHP4 provides a solution to this problem. Basically, two methods are used to submit a form, the Get or Post method. This method is declared in the HTML form with the attribute named 'method'. The values submitted in a form can be accessed through the '\$HTTP_GET_VARS' variable, if we use the Get method. While using the Post method the values are accessed through the '\$HTTP_POST_VARS' variable. The example below gives a clear idea how to read from any form with the help of \$HTTP_GET_VARS array:

Example:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>List of the values inserted in a
form</title>
</head>
<body>
<?php
foreach ( $HTTP_GET_VARS as $key=>$val )
{
print "$key => $val<BR>\n";
}
?>
</body>
</html>
```

The above code displays the names and values of different parameters passed through the GET transaction. The above code will yield an output if each form element accepts a single value. If the form element accepts multiple values, then the above code will not be able to show those values. This problem can be solved by testing the data type of each element in \$HTTP_GET_VARS or \$HTTP_POST_VARS and by treating them accordingly. The code below tests the data type of every element in \$HTTP_GET_VARS. It changes the output accordingly.

Example:

```
<html>
```